

DSAIL- HW10

Tomas Salaz

April 13, 2026

Problem 1

When using the Union-Find data structure with rank, If an object x is not the set leader, then $rank(x) < rank(x.leader)$. For a set X , $size(X) \geq 2^{rank(x.leader)}$. Since there are n objects the highest possible rank is $O(\log n)$, and only leaders can change rank. There are also at most $n/2^r$ objects with rank r .

If there are m **MakeSet**, **Union**, and **FindSet** operations, n of them are **MakeSet** the total cost of all operations is $\Theta(m \log n)$

Proof by Induction on rank k of tree T

BC: $k = 0$ implies that a tree has a single root node, so $k = 2^0 = 1$ thus the root node has rank 0. **IH:** For all $j < k$, a tree T of rank j contains at least 2^j nodes.

IS: A tree of rank k is only created when 2 Trees of rank $k - 1$ are unified, $T = \text{Union}(T_1, T_2)$. By the IH, each subtree has at least 2^{k-1} nodes, so T has $2^{k-1} + 2^{k-1} = 2^k$ nodes.

The Proof above implies that is we have n total nodes and $2^k \leq n$, then $k \leq \log n$, thus the maximum rank of any tree is at most $\log n$.

Without Path Compression, Rank=Height for any tree T , therefore $Height(T) \leq \log n$. Thus any **FindSet** operation is also bounded by the height. **MakeSet** and **Union** each cost $O(1)$, so over m operations the total cost in the worst case is $\Theta(m \log n)$.

Consider a sequence of **FindSet** operations on a node at the max depth. Since the Height of the tree is bounded by $\Theta(\log n)$ and each operation takes $\Theta(\log n)$ time, performing m operations costs a total of $\Theta(m \log n)$ thus proving the bound.

Problem 2

The algorithm Takes in a Connected Weighted Graph G with weight function $w : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ and Outputs a Minimum-weight Cycle Cover, F where $F \subseteq E$.

Algo Begin

1. Find Max-Weight Span Tree, T , of G . Using Kruskal's Algo and with edges sorted in decreasing weight.

2. Return MaxSpan Tree Edges, F

$F = E - T$ (Elements in Edge Set that are NOT in Max-Span

Algo End

For Step 1, Sort all edges E in decreasing order. Init T , the Max-Weight Span Tree, to be Empty and init a Union-Find with each vertex in its own set.

For each edge (u, v) : if $\text{FIND}(u) \neq \text{FIND}(v)$ then $\text{UNION}(u, v)$ to add to T . Stop When T has $n - 1$ edges.

Correctness

We must show 2 things: (1). F is a Cycle Cover and (2) F has min total weight among all Cycle Covers.

(1). The construction of T is acyclic and connects all vertices. Removing F where $F = (E - T)$ from G leaves the edges in T that form a Tree. Since T is spanning and acyclic, any cycle in G must contain at least one edge not in T . Therefore, every cycle cover contains at least one edge in $F = E - T$, so F is a cycle cover.

(2). Let F' be any Cycle Cover for G , then $E - F'$ is also acyclic, and since G is connected then $E - F'$ must be a subgraph that contains some spanning tree. we also know that $\text{Weight}(E - F') \leq \text{Weight}(T')$ where T' is the max weight spanning tree of the subgraph $E - F'$. T' is also a spanning tree of G . Thus, $\text{Weight}(F') = \text{Weight}(E - F') \geq \text{Weight}(E) - \text{Weight}(T) = \text{Weight}(F)$
So $\text{Weight}(F) \leq \text{Weight}(F')$ for any cycle cover F' thus F is the min weight.

Run Time

Sorting the edges by decreasing weight take $O(m \log m) = O(m \log n)$ time since $m \leq n^2$.

The main loop for Kruskal's has m iterations, each doing 2 $\text{FIND}()$ operations and at most 1 $\text{UNION}()$. With Union by Rank and Path compression, the Runtime is $O(m \log^* n) = O(m)$.

Computing $F = E - T$ iterates through all m edges and checks membership in T , Using a Hash Set for T , this has $O(m)$ runtime.

The Total runtime is $O(m \log n)$

Problem 3

Proof by Counter Example

Let $G = (V, E)$ with $V = a, b, c, d$ and the weight of the edges be $(a, b) = 5$, $(a, c) = 1$, and $(a, d) = 3$.

G is a tree since it is Connected and Acyclic, so there must be a unique Spanning Tree. This tree is simple and its $MST = \{(a, b), (a, c), (a, d)\}$.

Let $A = \{(a, b)\}$. Since (a, b) is an element of T , A is included in the MST of G .

Let $S = \{a, b\}$ and $V - S = \{c, d\}$. The Cut $(S, V - S)$ respects A because the only edge in A is (a, b) and both its endpoints are within S , so they do not cross the Cut.

The only edges crossing the cut are (a, c) and (a, d) , so the Light Edge of the cut is (a, c) since the weight is 1.

A Safe Edge implies that a MST exists and contains $A \cup \{(a, d)\} = \{(a, b), (a, d)\}$. The unique MST , T , contains both edges so (a, d) is safe, but is not the Light Edge for the cut.

Thus, a Graph G , a set $A \subset MST$, a cut $(S, V - S)$ and a crossing cut safe edge (a, d) is not the lightest edge in the crossing cut, Therefore the converse of the safe edge theorem is false.

Problem 4

If an edge (u, v) is in some Min-Span-Tree for graph G the (u, v) is a light edge crossing some cut in G

Proof

Let T be the MST of G and contains the edge (u, v) . To construct a cut, we remove the edge (u, v) from T . Since T is a tree, removing any edge disconnects it into 2 connected components.

Let S be the vertex set containing the component u and let $V - S$ be the vertex set containing v .

The partition $(S, V - S)$ defined the cut of G , and by construction if, u is an element in S and v is an element in $V - S$, so (u, v) crosses the cut.

To show that (u, v) is a light edge, we can prove this using contradiction.

Suppose (u, v) is NOT a light edge for the cut $(S, V - S)$, Then another crossing edge, (x, y) exists that is lighter, $Weight(x, y) < Weight(u, v)$ and x is element in S and y is an element in $V - S$.

Consider the edge set, $T' = (T - \{(u, v)\}) \cup \{(x, y)\}$.

If T' is a Spanning Tree of G , then T' connects all vertices, So removing (u, v) and replacing with (x, y) reconnects them since u and x are in the same set AND v and y are in the same set. Thus T' has $n - 1$ edges and remains connected, so it is still spanning tree.

Since

$$Weight(T') = Weight(T) - Weight(u, v) + Weight(x, y)$$

and

$$Weight(x, y) < Weight(u, v)$$

Then T' is a spanning tree with a smaller total weight than T , thus contradicting the assumption that T is a Min-Span-Tree.